

When Israel was in Egypt's land

Text: African American spiritual

Music: African American spiritual

GO DOWN MOSES 85.85 with refrain

arr. John W. Work (1871-1925)

The musical score is written for a single melodic line in 4/4 time, featuring a key signature of two flats (Bb and Eb). The score is divided into four systems, each with a treble clef and a key signature of two flats. The first system begins with a 'Unison' instruction and a 'Gm' chord, followed by a 'Harmony' section with 'D7' and 'Gm' chords. The second system also starts with 'Unison' and 'Gm', followed by 'Harmony' with 'D7' and 'Gm'. The third system begins with 'Gm' and 'Cm', followed by 'Gm' and 'D7', and ends with 'Gm'. The fourth system starts with 'Cm7', followed by 'Gm', 'D', 'Gm', 'D7', and ends with 'Gm'. The lyrics are written below the notes, with some words in parentheses indicating alternative phrasings. The score concludes with a double bar line.

1 When Is - rael was in E - gypt's land, let my peo-ple go,
2 The Lord told Mo - ses what to do, let my peo-ple go,
3 As Is - rael stood by wa - ter's side, let my peo-ple go,
op - pressed so hard they could not stand, let my peo-ple go.
to lead the He - brew chil - dren through, let my peo-ple go.
at God's com-mand it did di - vide, let my peo-ple go.
Go down, Mo - ses, way down in E - gypt's land,
tell old Pha - raoh: let my peo-ple go.

4. When they had reached the other shore,
let my people go,
they let the song of triumph soar,
let my people go.

5. Lord, help us all from bondage flee,
let my people go,
and let us all in Christ be free,
let my people go.